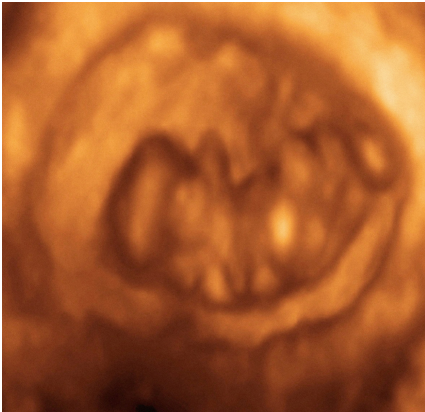




YOU ARE **8 WEEKS AND 6 DAYS**

218 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

This 3D ultrasound scan shows a baby lying on its back, in exactly the same orientation as the image opposite. It is just possible to pick out the limb buds on an ultrasound scan taken at this stage.

“It’s not long until you have your first prenatal appointment and will see your doctor.”

Soon you will have your initial appointment (see [Ask a doctor](#)) with the doctor. If you haven’t made an appointment for this yet, contact your doctor or local maternity unit to arrange it. You may or may not have a choice of hospitals.

If you do have options, talk to women you know locally who have had their babies at those hospitals to find out about their experience. For example, some hospitals may have a birth center attached, and have a less medically managed approach to childbirth.

Start thinking now about the kind of questions you want to ask your doctor. It’s a good idea to write these down before you attend the appointment. Also make a note, in advance, of the key details of your medical history, medication you’re taking, and any pregnancy symptoms.

TACKLING COLDS

Cold medicines contain a variety of ingredients, including antihistamines, that are best avoided in pregnancy. Check the label and talk to your doctor or pharmacist before taking any medications.

Try natural remedies, such as steam inhalations or saline nasal sprays, before resorting to medication.

ASK A PANEL ABOUT HOME BIRTH

It’s my first pregnancy. Can I have a home birth?

Midwife: if you’re in good health with no complications, giving birth at home is an option. Many women enjoy the experience of giving birth at home, because they may feel more comfortable with familiar surroundings and people. Some women find labor easier when they get into water, either a familiar bathtub at home or a birthing pool that has been purchased or rented.